

Stairway to Heaven -- Led Zeppelin

Led Zeppelin IV, 1971. Starts ~72 BPM and speeds up toward the end.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

John Paul Jones is on keys and recorders early on. The bass doesn't come in until the full band enters in the middle section.

Two sounds matter: a warm, round, supportive tone for the build, and a pushed, growly hard-rock tone for the solo and "And as we wind on down the road" ending.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg810 IR (User IR 3)

SVT into an 8x10 is the classic big-rock bass stack. It's the most direct Ampeg pairing in the IR library.

MidFreq sits at 450Hz for low-mid warmth, the woody body JPJ's Jazz bass has on this track, not modern clank.

- Gain: 32. Clean, with enough warmth for the build.
- Bass: 60.
- Middle: 55, MidFreq: 450Hz.
- Treble: 50.
- VOL: 65. CAB VOL: 60.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 15.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 45.

Level push for the ending. The band gets much louder and the bass has to move up with it.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 35, Blend: 40, VOL: 60, Bass: 52, Treble: 52.

Adds the grind for the hard-rock section. Blend at 40 keeps the clean SVT foundation under it.

The boost hits the OD first, so together they stack into a bigger sound than either one alone.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 32, Bass 60, Middle 55, MidFreq 450Hz, Treble 50, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 3 (Apg810), always on. VOL 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1, always on.

33Hz: +2, 150Hz: +2, 600Hz: +1, 2kHz: +2, 8kHz: -1, VOL: 54.

Full lows, a bit of low-mid body, and 2kHz for definition when things get loud. Top slightly tamed.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- Room, always on.

Mix: 12, Decay: 25, Trail: on.

A little room around the bass fits the live-room feel of the record in both states.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and DST (Bass OD).

- **CTL off**: the middle-section build, from when the band enters up to the solo. Warm, round, supportive. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on**: guitar solo and the hard-rock ending. Boost plus OD stack for a pushed, growly SVT.

Engage at the drum fill into the solo. Leave it on through the end, then kill it for the quiet "And she's buying a stairway to heaven" tag.